Day 12 - Iroquoia Heights, Scenic Woods, Robert MacLaren, Hillcrest Ave

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Iroquoia section · hike 18 · Chedoke & Iroquoia Heights, Hamilton

12.7 km / 7.9 mi	~3.9 h	2.4 km new	49 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

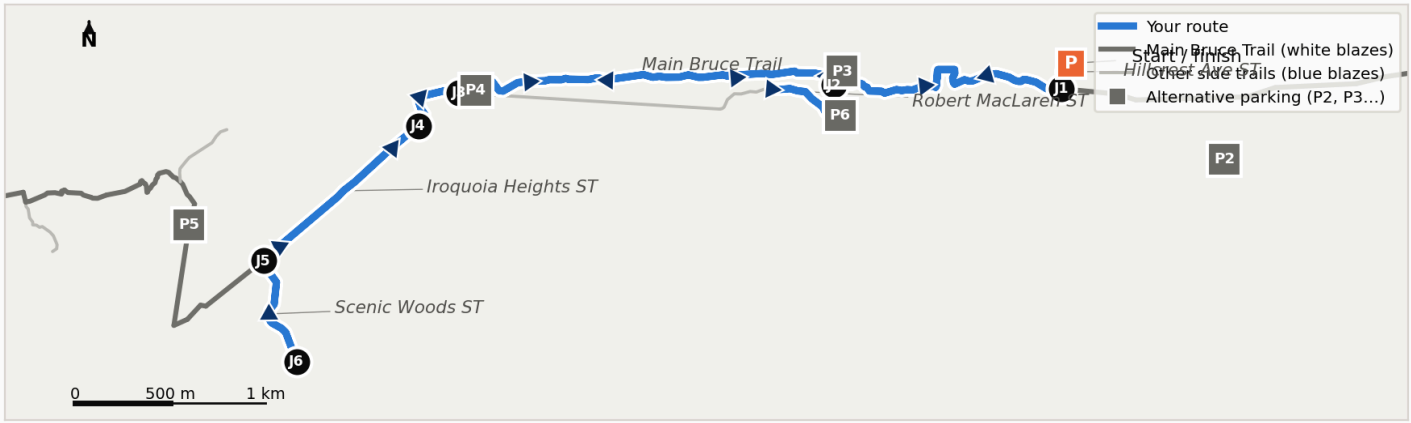
Park (P): Roadside parking at the east end of Hillcrest Ave providing access to the Chedoke Radial Trail. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day12_hike018.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Iroquoia Heights Side Trail (1.1 km); Scenic Woods Side Trail (0.6 km); Robert MacLaren Side Trail (0.6 km); Hillcrest Ave Side Trail (0.2 km)

Route map

Day 12 | 12.7 km (7.9 mi)



What to expect

- **Parking:** Roadside at the east end of Hillcrest Ave, with access to the Chedoke Radial Trail.
- **Main Bruce Trail:** Runs beside the Chedoke Radial Trail, a former railway line (1908-1931). A 2015 trip report describes a long set of steps up to a Lower Chedoke Falls lookout, metal steps near the Chedoke golf club, and woods and open meadows through Iroquoia Heights Conservation Area. Expect stairs.
- **Iroquoia Heights Side Trail:** Mapped as nearly level (about 1% average grade), running from near Scenic Dr and forming a loop with the main trail through Iroquoia Heights Conservation Area.
- **Scenic Falls:** Near the west end of the Chedoke Radial Trail by Scenic Dr, a roughly 18 m falls in a small gorge. It is best after heavy rain, and trees limit the view. Details of the Scenic Woods Side Trail itself were not found.
- **Robert MacLaren and Hillcrest Ave side trails:** Short connectors; no further details were found.
- **Length:** At 12.9 km this is a long day; plan water and rest stops for Zappy.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	St map	Paid: $4.50 per 30 min, $24 daily max	0.2	1610 m	
P3	Chedoke Golf Club: Access from Beddoe Dr off Studholme Rd, south of Aberdeen Ave map	Free	1.7	120 m	Robert MacLaren
P4	Parking lot on Scenic Dr, west of Chateau Court is a parking lot under the hydro towers map	Free	3.7	120 m	Iroquoia Heights
P5	Roadside parking at the end of Filman Road map	Free	5.2	1190 m	
P6	Parking lot on Upper Paradise Rd, north of Scenic Dr map	Free	10.2	90 m	Robert MacLaren

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions

0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside parking at the east end of Hillcrest Ave providing access to the Chedoke Radial…. Walk about 30 m to the trail. Head south-west on the blue-blazed Hillcrest Ave Side Trail.
0.2	0.1	J1: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
1.6	1.0	J2: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading north-west. (the blue-blazed Robert MacLaren Side Trail goes off on your left.)
3.7	2.3	J3: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the blue-blazed Robert MacLaren Side Trail goes off behind you.) There is trailhead parking here (Parking lot on Scenic Dr, west of Chateau Court is a parking lot under the hydro towers).
4.1	2.6	J4: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Iroquoia Heights Side Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
5.2	3.2	J5: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Scenic Woods Side Trail, heading south-east. (the blue-blazed Iroquoia Heights Side Trail goes off ahead.)
5.8	3.6	J6: End of the Scenic Woods Side Trail. Turn around and retrace your steps.
6.4	4.0	J5: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Iroquoia Heights Side Trail, heading north-east. (the blue-blazed Iroquoia Heights Side Trail goes off on your left.)
7.5	4.7	J4: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off behind you.)
7.9	4.9	J3: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the blue-blazed Robert MacLaren Side Trail goes off ahead.) There is trailhead parking here (Parking lot on Scenic Dr, west of Chateau Court is a parking lot under the hydro towers).
10.0	6.2	J2: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Robert MacLaren Side Trail, heading south. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off ahead.) This is a short excursion (about 1130 m in all): walk the whole Robert MacLaren Side Trail, including the short loop or branch near its end (see the map), and come back to this junction.
11.1	6.9	J2: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading east. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
12.5	7.8	J1: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Hillcrest Ave Side Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
12.7	7.9	Leave the trail and walk back to the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on a 2015 Bruce Trail trip report, Hiking Project and GoWaterfalling.